Aga Khan University Examination Board

Notes from E-Marking Centre on HSSC-II Pakistan Studies Examination May 2017

Introduction

This document has been produced for the teachers and candidates of Higher Secondary School Certificate (HSSC-II) Pakistan Studies. It contains comments on candidates' responses to the 2017 HSSC-II Examination, indicating the quality of the responses and highlighting their relative strengths and weaknesses.

E-Marking Notes

This includes overall comments on students' performance on every question and some specific examples of students' responses which support the mentioned comments. Please note that the descriptive comments represent an overall perception of the better and weaker responses as gathered from the e-marking session. However, the candidates' responses shared in this document represent some specific example(s) of the mentioned comments.

Teachers and candidates should be aware that examiners may ask questions that address the Student Learning Outcomes (SLOs) in a manner that require candidates to respond by integrating knowledge, understanding and application skills they have developed during the course of study. Candidates are advised to read and comprehend each question carefully before writing the response to fulfil the demand of the question.

Candidates need to be aware that the marks allocated to the questions are related to the answer space provided on the examination paper as a guide to the length of the required response. A longer response will not in itself lead to higher marks. Candidates need to be familiar with the command words in the Student Learning Outcomes which contain terms commonly used in examination questions. However, candidates should also be aware that not all questions will start with or contain one of the command words. Words such as 'how', 'why' or 'what' may also be used.

The paper of Pakistan Studies at this level comprises of several components. This year the candidates did fairly well the questions which required more of a general approach. Whereas, it was generally felt that the students lack basic historical and cultural knowledge necessary to answer various questions. Most candidates performed poorly in questions dealing with geography and foreign policy part. However some candidates produced good responses to questions from these sections well. It seemed that the candidates were not well prepared to answer questions from these topics. It was also observed that students do not spend time in reading questions which lead to poor answers as in most cases students prepared a general response which they write without realizing the demand of the question.

Note: Student responses reproduced in this report have not been corrected for grammar, spelling, format or factual information.

Detailed Comments:

Constructed Response Questions (CRQs)

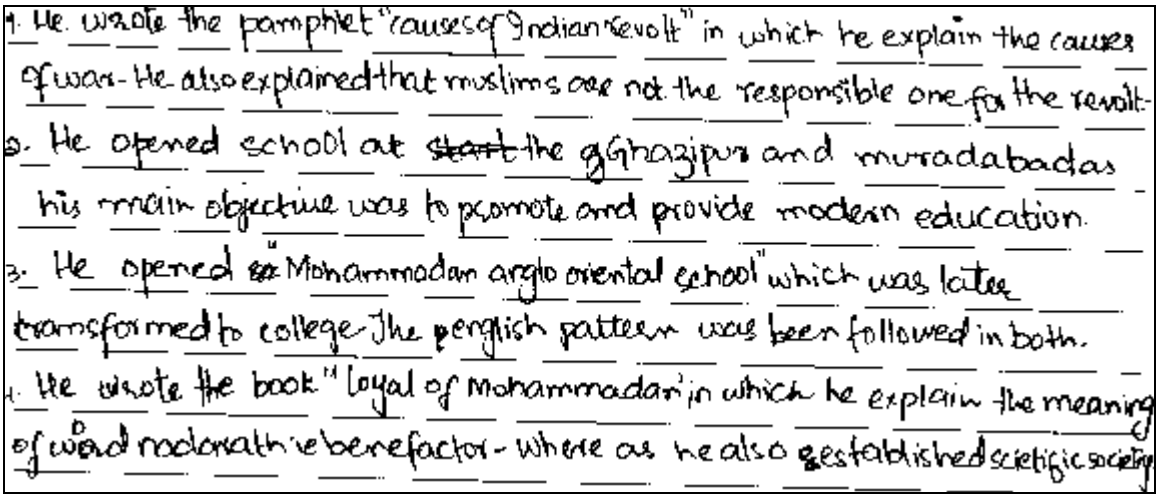
Question 1:

The Aligarh Movement was a valuable service rendered by Sir Syed Ahmed Khan and his colleagues for the renaissance of the Muslims of the subcontinent.

Describe any FOUR steps taken by Sir Syed Ahmed Khan at the start of this movement.

Better responses were those in which the candidates mentioned the practical steps taken by Sir Syed Ahmed Khan for the upliftment and emancipation of the Muslims of the subcontinent. The responses included establishment of the MAO College, establishment of Scientific Society, establishment of madrasas in Moradabad and Ghazipur, etc. Better responses also mentioned various pamphlets and books written by Sir Syed Ahmed Khan such as 'The Causes of Indian Revolt', 'The Loyal Muhammadans of India' and 'Tabyin-ul-Kalam', etc. Apart from these, other organisations established by Sir Syed Ahmed Khan for the betterment of the Muslims of the subcontinent were also regarded as part of the better response, which included, Muhammadan Educational Conference and Anjuman-e-Taraqqi-i-Urdu. etc.

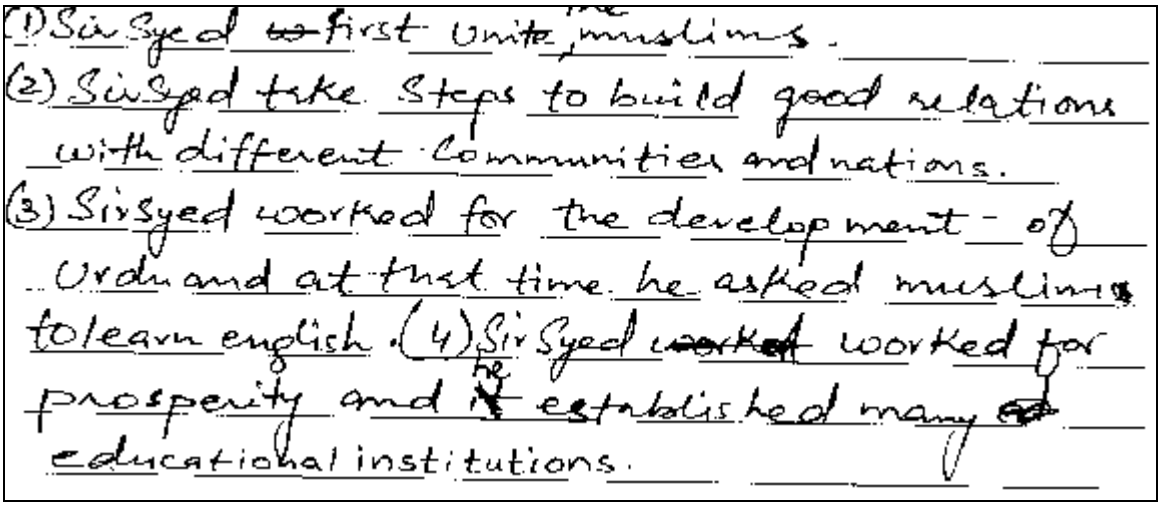
Example:



1. He wrote the pamphlet "causes of Indian revolt" in which he explain the causes of war. He also explained that muslims are not the responsible one for the revolt.
2. He opened school at ~~start~~ the Ghazipur and muradabad as his main objective was to promote and provide modern education.
3. He opened "Mohammadan anglo oriental school" which was latter transformed to college. The english pattern was been followed in both.
4. He wrote the book "loyal of Mohammadan" in which he explain the meaning of word nationalism. He was a benefactor - where as he also gestablished scietific society

Weaker responses talked about Sir Syed Ahmed Khan's advice and services to the Muslims of the subcontinent without providing any specific factual reference. Weaker responses mainly focused on Sir Syed's efforts to unite Muslim leaders to start the Aligarh Movement. Sir Syed Ahmed Khan was also incorrectly credited with the establishment of All India Muslim League and start of the Pakistan Movement.

Example:


(1) Sir Syed ~~was~~ first Unite muslims.
(2) Sir Syed take Steps to build good relations with different Communities and nations.
(3) Sir Syed worked for the development of Urdu and at that time he asked muslims to learn english. (4) Sir Syed ~~worked~~ worked for prosperity and he established many educational institutions.

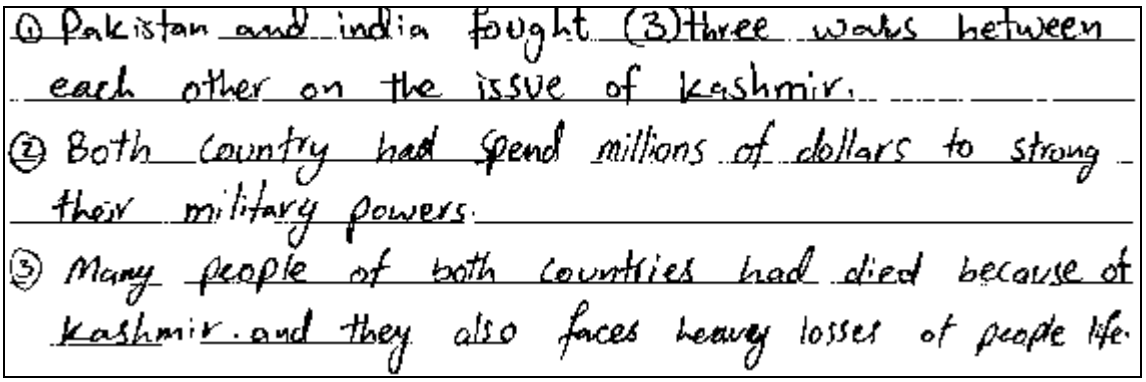
Question 2:

The Kashmir issue is the biggest obstacle between Pak-India relations.

Mention any THRRE relevant facts to support the given statement.

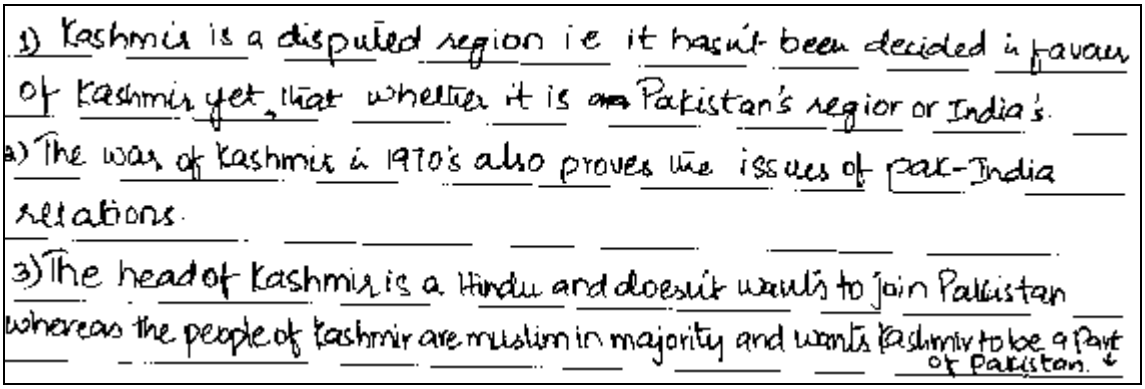
Better responses highlighted the relevant facts to support the statement which included that India and Pakistan have fought three wars over Kashmir: in 1947, 1965, and 1999; huge deployment of troops on both sides of the border; contributed towards the start of nuclear rivalry and reason behind the failure of peace negotiations between India and Pakistan. Better response also mentioned the issue of Baglihar Dam over Chenab in Jammu and Kashmir, which is causing a "loss of agriculture" for farmers in Pakistan.

Example:


① Pakistan and india fought (3) three wars between each other on the issue of kashmir.
② Both country had spend millions of dollars to strong their military powers.
③ Many people of both countries had died because of kashmir. and they also faces heavy losses of people life.

Weaker responses merely focused on the historical background of the Kashmir issue. They mostly discussed the injustice done by the Radcliffe Boundary Commission during the division of Punjab and also criticised the decision of Maharaja of Kashmir to accede with India. Some of the candidates also mentioned the natural beauty of Kashmir and its natural resources which was irrelevant.

Example:

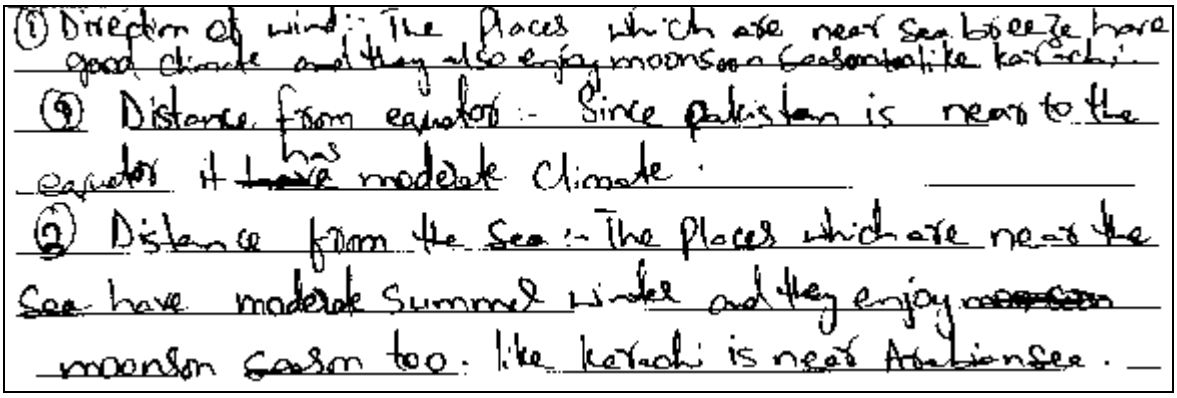

1) Kashmir is a disputed region ie it hasn't been decided in favour of Kashmir yet, that whether it is Pakistan's region or India's.
2) The war of Kashmir in 1970's also proves the issues of pak-India relations.
3) The head of Kashmir is a Hindu and doesn't wants to join Pakistan whereas the people of Kashmir are muslim in majority and wants Kashmir to be a part of Pakistan.

Question 3:

Explain any THREE factors which affect the climate of a place.

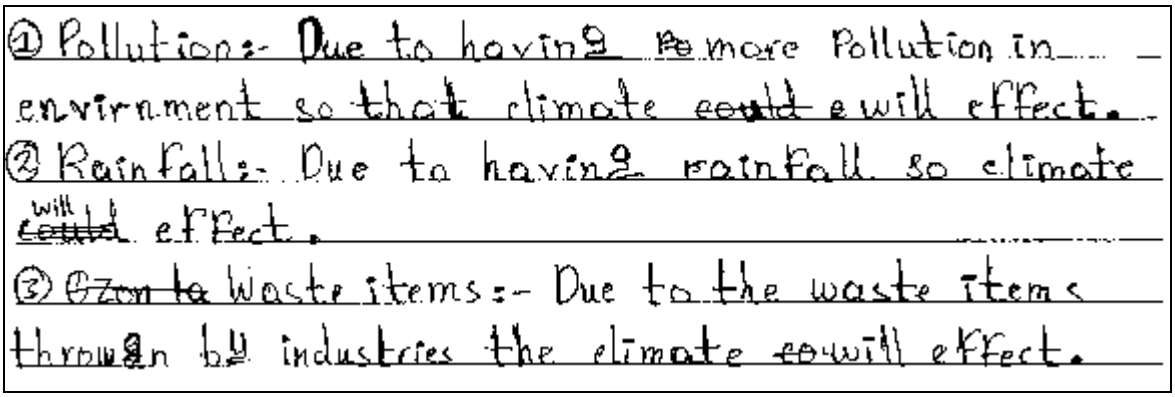
Better responses were those which had mentioned the natural factors that affect climate of a place. These include elevation or altitude**,** distance from the sea, direction of prevailing winds, distance from the equator, direction of mountains, etc.

Example:


(1) Direction of wind:- The places which are near sea breeze have good climate and they also enjoy moonson season like karachi.
(2) Distance from equator:- Since pakistan is near to the equator it has moderate climate.
(3) Distance from the Sea:- The places which are near the Sea have moderate Summer winter and they enjoy moonson season too. like karachi is near Arabian Sea.

Weaker responses generally mentioned the environmental problems such as air pollution, water pollution, land pollution, etc. instead of mentioning the natural factors that affect the climate of a place. Some of the responses also mentioned cyclones, storms, western depression, monsoon rain, etc.

Example:

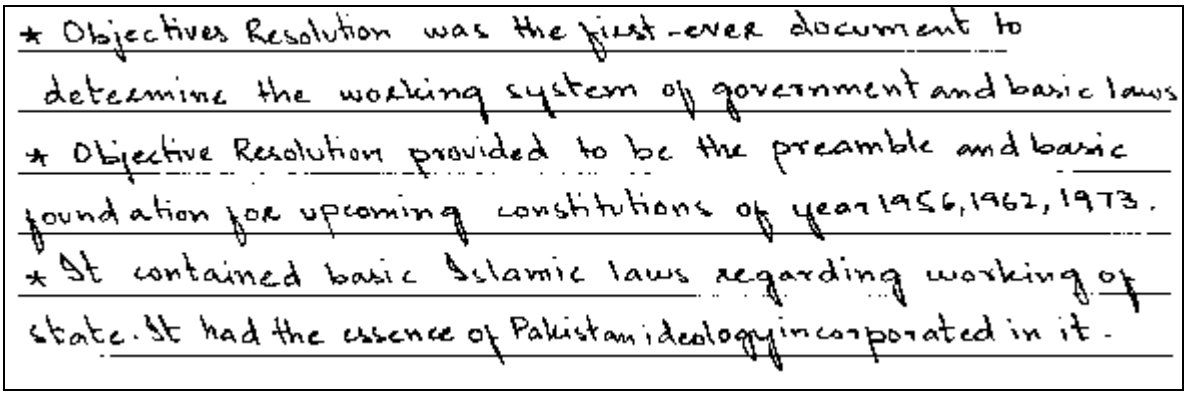


Question 4:

Why is the Objectives Resolution of 1949 considered to be the most important document in the constitutional history of Pakistan?

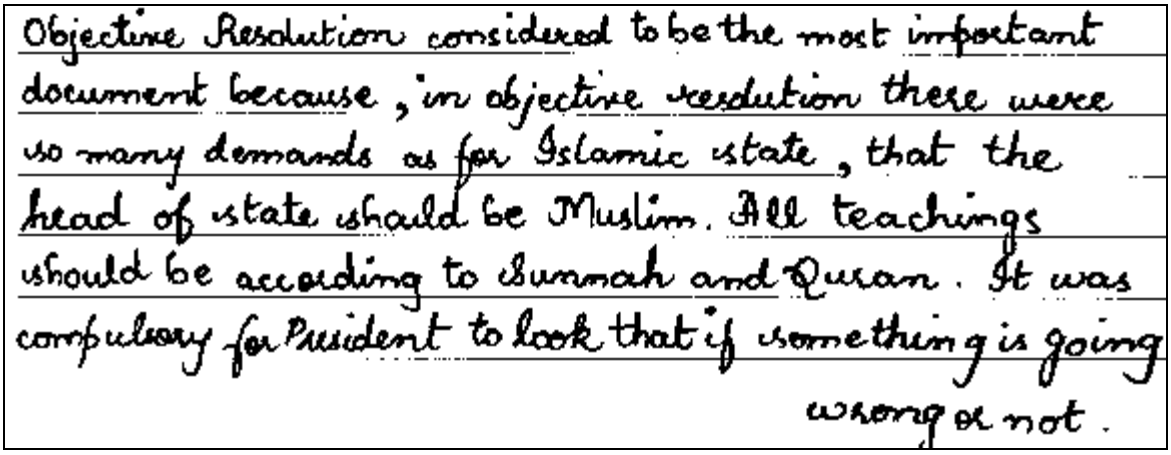
Better responses were those which highlighted the importance of Objectives Resolution 1949 in the constitutional history of Pakistan. They include, Objectives Resolution lays *emphasis* on the *principles* of *democracy*, freedom, equality, tolerance, and social justice; it ensures the implementation of Islamic laws in Pakistan; it mentions rights and religious freedom of minorities; it was used as a Preamble in all three constitutions of the country, etc.

Example:

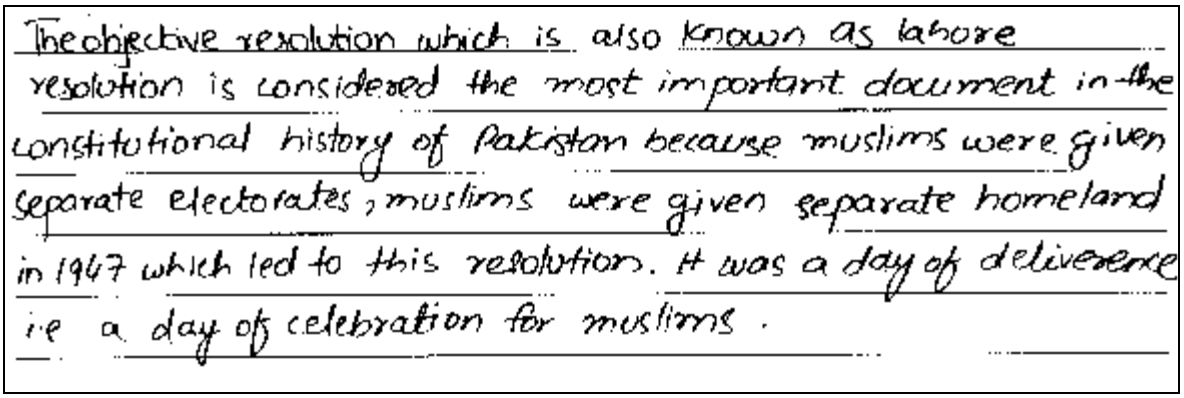


Weaker responses could not comprehend the question and mentioned the clauses of Objectives Resolution 1949. Most of the students merely mentioned that it was presented by Liaquat Ali Khan and used as a first constitutional draft. Many students confused Objectives Resolution 1949 with the Pakistan Resolution 1940 and described its importance in the freedom movement.

Example1:

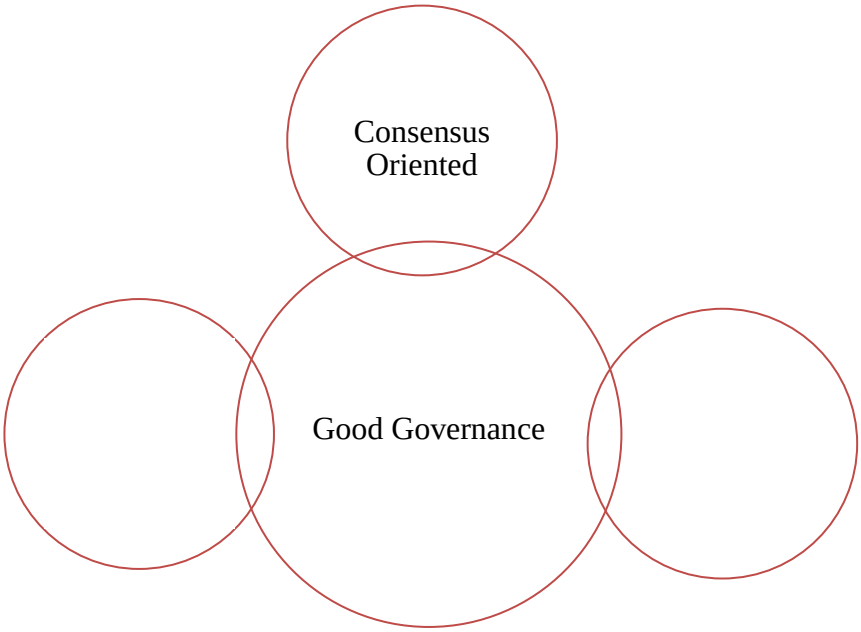

Objective Resolution considered to be the most important document because, in objective resolution there were so many demands as for Islamic state, that the head of state should be Muslim. All teachings should be according to Sunnah and Quran. It was compulsory for President to look that if something is going wrong or not.

Example 2:


The objective resolution which is also known as lahore resolution is considered the most important document in the constitutional history of Pakistan because muslims were given separate electorates, muslims were given separate homeland in 1947 which led to this resolution. It was a day of deliverence ie a day of celebration for muslims.

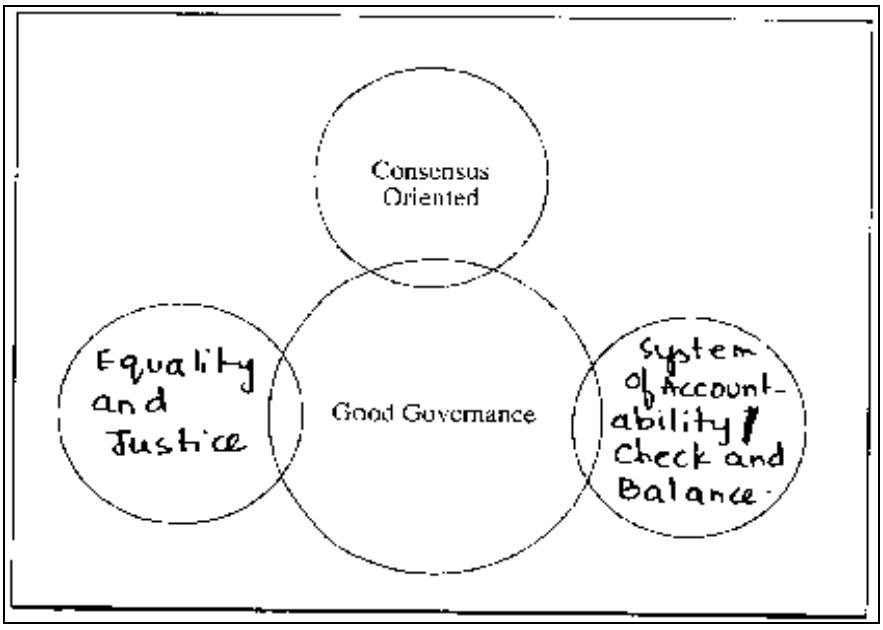
Question 5:

Mention any TWO characteristics of good governance in the given text circles. One has been done for your reference.



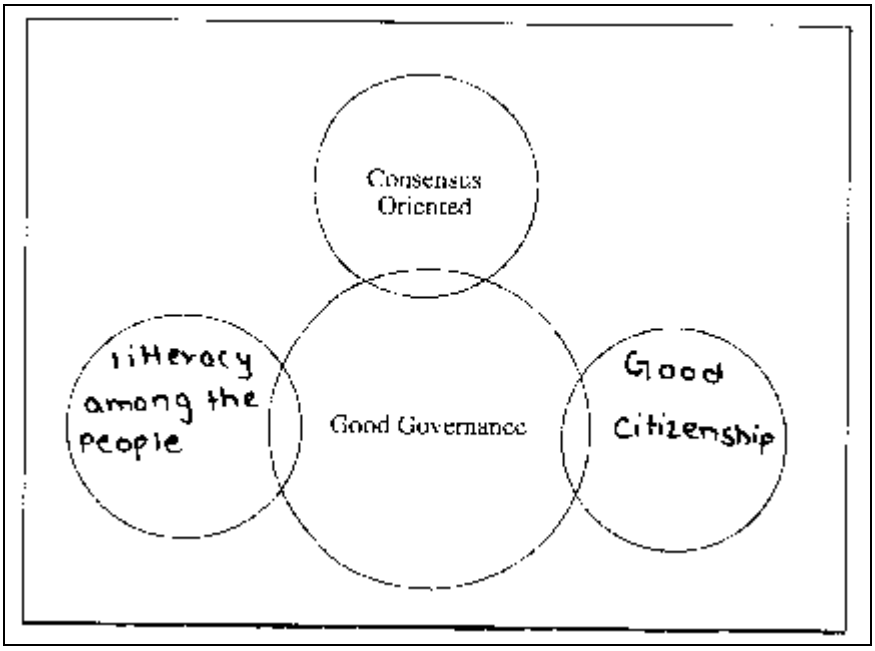
Better responses were those in which the candidates provided appropriate characteristics of good governance. They included, public participation, rule of law, responsiveness, equity and inclusiveness, effectiveness and efficiency, accountability, transparency, social justice, devolution of powers to local government, etc.

Example:



Weaker responses were the ones in which the candidates were unable to grasp the question clearly, hence, provided very vague points such as free education, health facilities, economic development, good citizens, etc.

Example:



Question 6:

Pushto is a language dominantly spoken in the Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province of Pakistan.

Mention any TWO steps taken by the government for the promotion of Pushto language.

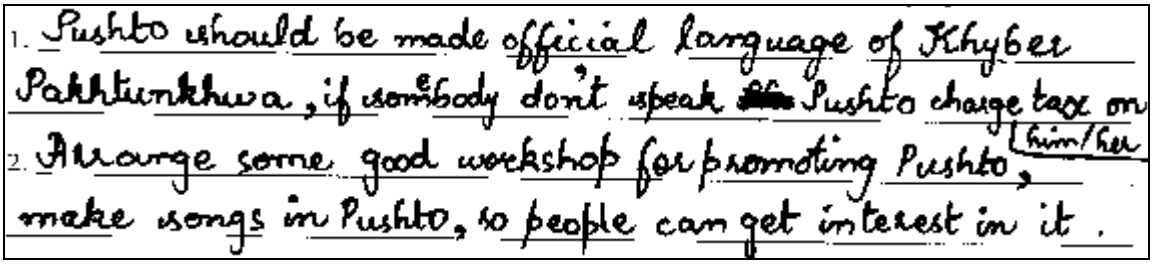
Better responses clearly mentioned the steps taken by the government for the promotion of Pushto language in Pakistan. These include establishment of the Pushto Language Academy; teaching Pushto language as a compulsory subject in school; universities in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa offer degree programmes in Pushto and specific programmes in Pushto language on national television and radio.

Example:

1. Pushto academy was also setup in 1954 under government to promote Pushto language as well as its literacture.
2. Many dramas got design in Pushto language plus radios also worked for this language and hence, language got enhance.

Weaker Responses merely described the Pushto cultural festivals and other events peculiar to Pashtun culture. Some of the candidates also talked about the services rendered by famous Pashtun writers and poets, etc. Many students provided suggestions instead of mentioning the steps already taken by the government.

Example:

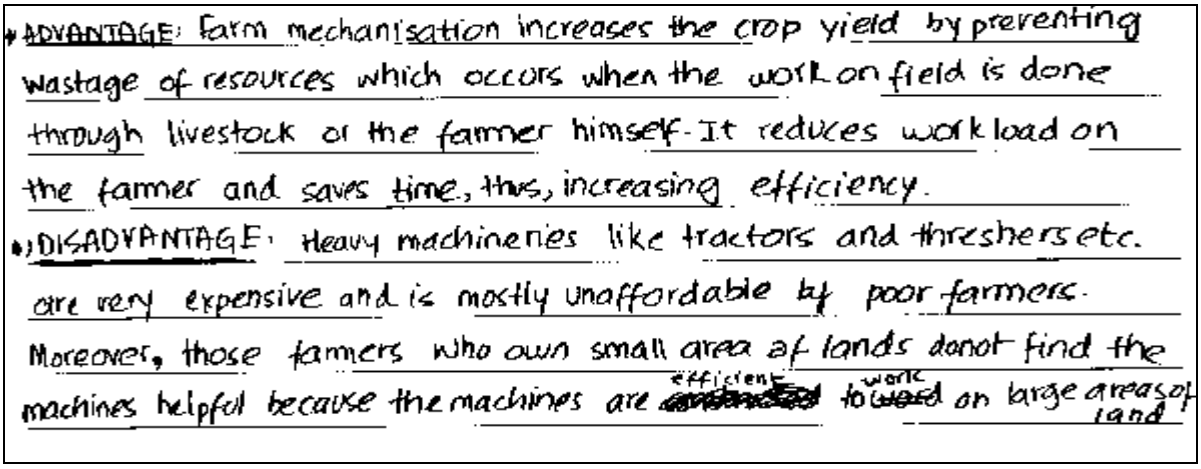

1. Pushto should be made official language of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, if somebody don't speak Pushto charge tax on him/her
2. Arrange some good workshop for promoting Pushto, make songs in Pushto, so people can get interest in it.

Question 7:

Explain any ONE advantage and disadvantage of farm mechanisation in developing countries.

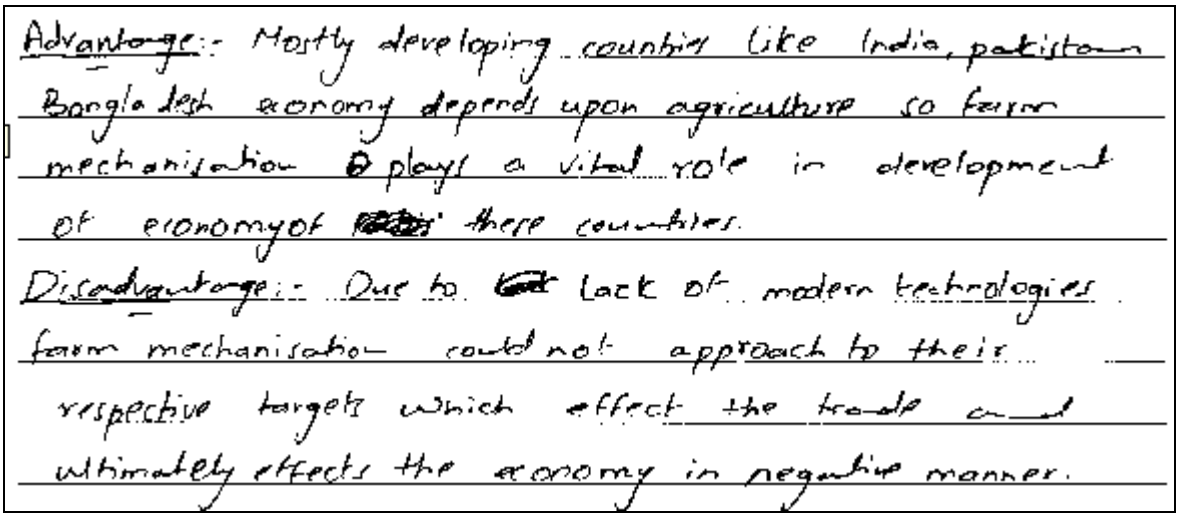
Better responses clearly provided an advantage and a disadvantage of farm mechanisation with a clear reason for each. Advantages included that the use of machinery decreases the cost of production; due to this, income of the farmer increases and the quality of production also improves; and the use of machinery relieves the farmers from exhausting physical labour, saves their time, etc. Disadvantages included that the use of machinery in agriculture in developing countries results in an increase in the rate of unemployment in the country; the initial cost of a machine is high and use of machines is not suitable for small land holdings, etc.

Example:


* ADVANTAGE: Farm mechanisation increases the crop yield by preventing wastage of resources which occurs when the work on field is done through livestock or the farmer himself. It reduces work load on the farmer and saves time, thus, increasing efficiency.
* DISADVANTAGE: Heavy machineries like tractors and threshers etc. are very expensive and is mostly unaffordable by poor farmers. Moreover, those farmers who own small area of lands donot find the machines helpful because the machines are efficient to work on large areas of land

Weaker responses were not able to provide the specific advantage and disadvantage of farm mechanisation and instead stated general comments such as it plays a vital role in the development; it affects the economy of a country, etc. It was a relatively easy question but many students were unable to answer the question properly.

Example:


Advantage:- Mostly developing countries like India, pakistan Bangladesh economy depends upon agriculture so farm mechanisation plays a vital role in development of economyof these countries.

Disadvantage:- Due to Lack of modern technologies farm mechanisation could not approach to their respective targets which effect the trade and ultimately effects the economy in negative manner.

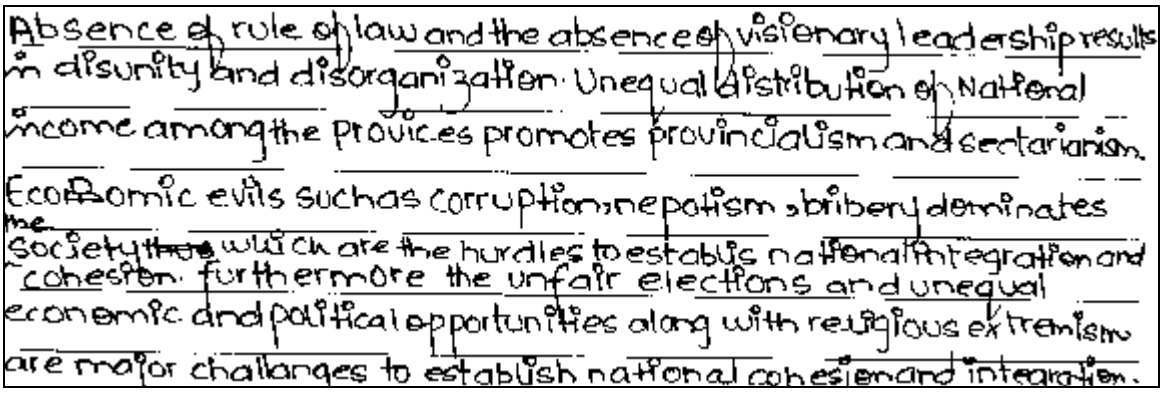
Question 8:

Almost all developing countries in the world are facing problems of national cohesion and integration.

What are the major challenges of national cohesion and integration in Pakistan?

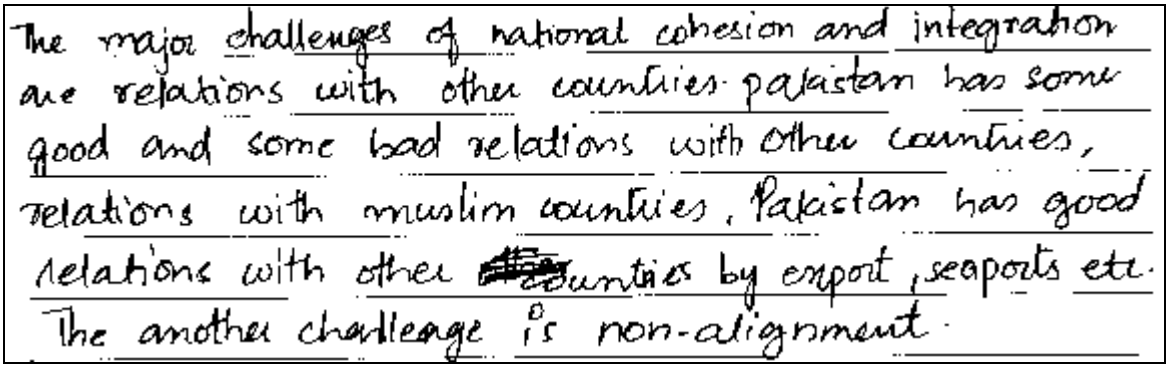
Better responses mentioned relevant hurdles to national cohesion and integration in Pakistan. They included political instability and failure of democracy; sectarian issues and involvement of foreign agencies; economic disparity between different regions; tension between central government and provincial governments; feudalism in the country, etc.

Example:

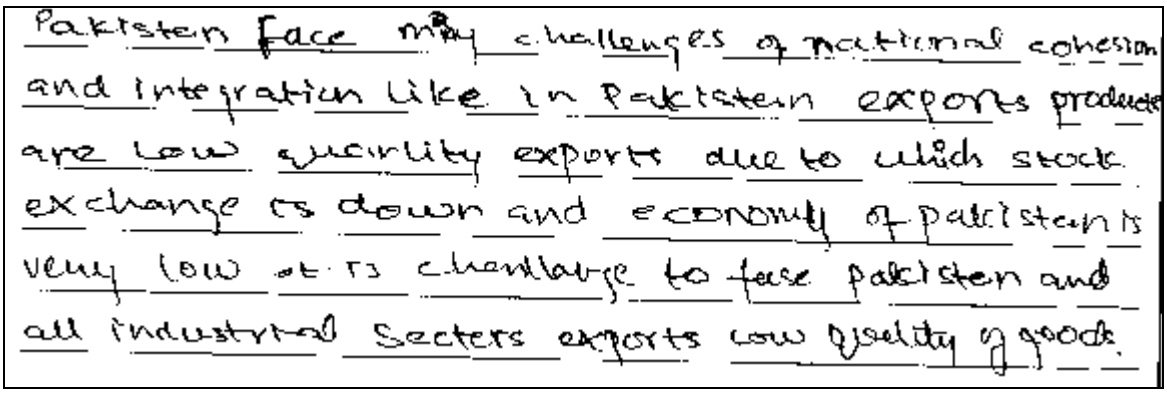

Absence of rule of law and the absence of visionary leadership results in disunity and disorganization. Unequal distribution of National income among the provinces promotes provincialism and sectarianism. Economic evils such as corruption, nepotism, bribery dominates the society which are the hurdles to establis national integration and cohesion. furthermore the unfair elections and unequal economic and political opportunities along with religious extremism are major challanges to establish national cohesion and integration.

Weaker responses were the ones where the candidates provided illogical or relevant points as challenge to national cohesion and integration. They included gender discrimination, caste system and cultural diversity, etc.

Example 1:


The major challenges of national cohesion and integration are relations with other countries. pakistan has some good and some bad relations with other countries, relations with muslim countries, Pakistan has good relations with other countries by export, seaports etc. The another challenge is non-alignment.

Example 2:

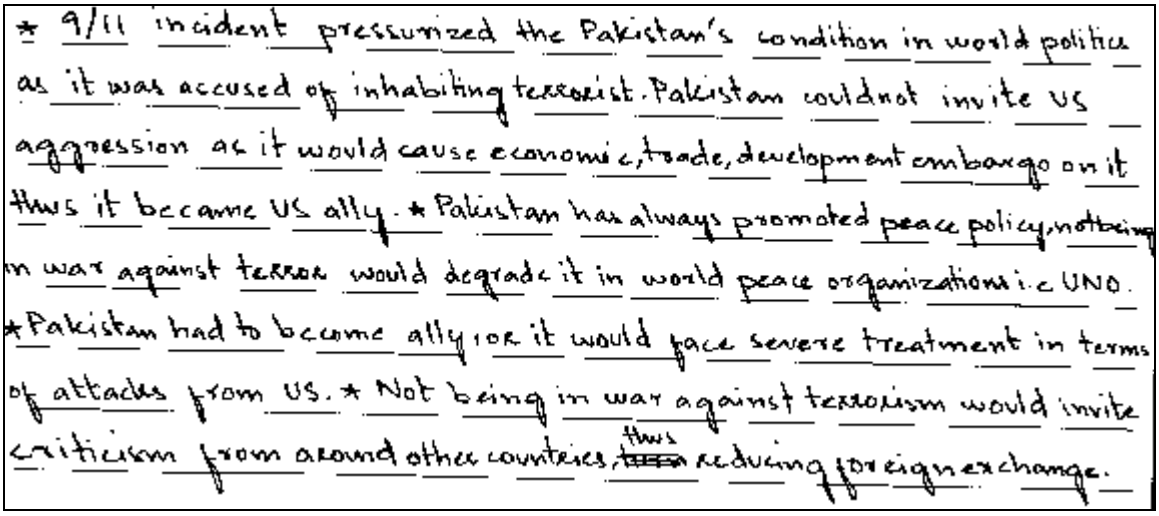

Pakistan face many challenges of national cohesion and integration like in Pakistan exports produce are low quality exports due to which stock exchange is down and economy of pakistan is very low it is challenge to face pakistan and all industrial secters exports low quality of goods.

Question 9:

Explain the reasons why Pakistan became an ally of the United States of America in the war against terrorism after the incident of 9/ 11.

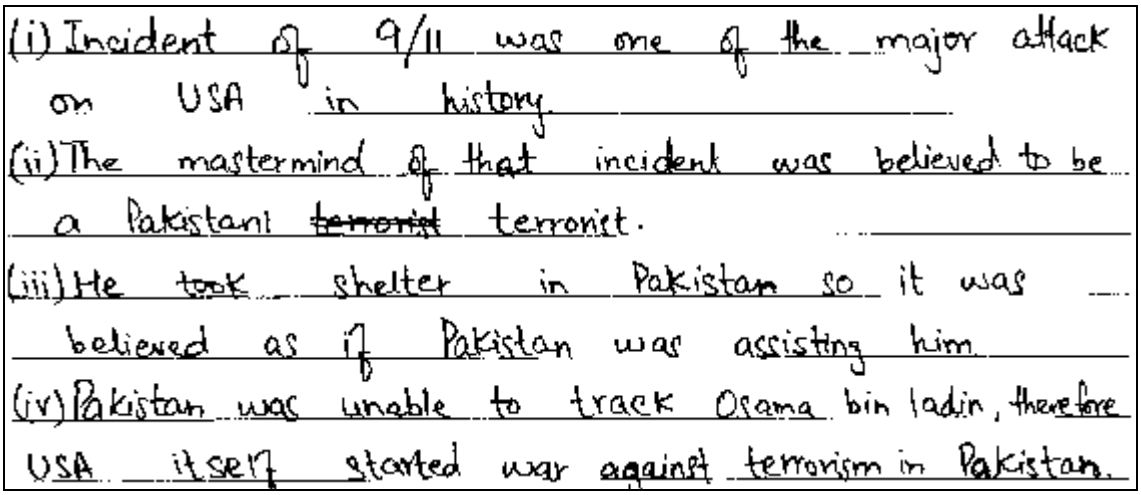
Better responses clearly mentioned the reasons because of which Pakistan decided to be an ally of the United States of America in the war against terrorism after the tragic incident of 9/ 11. They included desire to earn economic and military benefits; international pressure; threat to Pakistan's internal security and solidarity because of its geographical and cultural linkage with Afghanistan; to restore peace in the world because of being a member of UNO, etc.

Example:

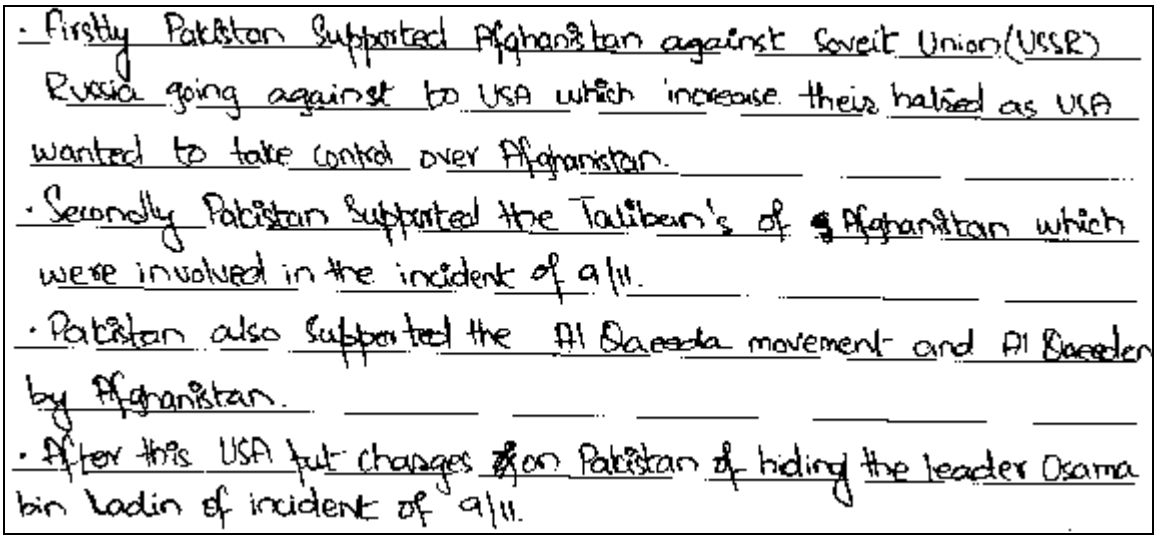

* 9/11 incident pressurized the Pakistan's condition in world politics as it was accused of inhabiting terrorist. Pakistan couldnot invite US aggression as it would cause economic, trade, development embargo on it thus it became US ally. * Pakistan has always promoted peace policy, nothing in war against terror would degrade it in world peace organizations i.e UNO. *Pakistan had to become ally or it would face severe treatment in terms of attacks from US. * Not being in war against terrorism would invite criticism from around other countries, thus reducing foreign exchange.

Weaker responses were unable to comprehend the question properly and wrote irrelevant points such as they both did not want Soviet Union to expand, they were good friends of each other and Pakistan was blamed for the attacks, etc. Many students also wrote about the history of US-Pakistan relations in detail.

Example 1:


(i) Incident of 9/11 was one of the major attack on USA in history.
(ii) The mastermind of that incident was believed to be a Pakistani ~~terrorist~~ terrorist.
(iii) He took shelter in Pakistan so it was believed as if Pakistan was assisting him.
(iv) Pakistan was unable to track Osama bin ladin, therefore USA itself started war against terrorism in Pakistan.

Example 2:


· Firstly Pakistan Supported Afghanistan against Soveit Union(USSR) Russia going against to USA which increase theirs hatred as USA wanted to take contol over Afghanistan.
· Secondly Pakistan Supported the Talibans of Afghanistan which were involved in the incident of 9/11.
· Pakistan also Supported the Al Qaeeda movement and Al Qaeeder by Afghanistan.
· After this USA put charges on Pakistan of hiding the leader Osama bin Ladin of incident of 9/11.

Extended Response Questions (ERQs)

The following questions offer choice between part **"a"** and **"b"**

Question 10:

It was an ERQ (extended response question). This question offered a choice between part **a** and **b**. Part **a** was based on history whereas part **b** was from the topic of economic development. Majority of the candidates attempted option **b**.

Question 10 a:

Discuss the THREE major recommendations proposed by Muhammad Ali Jinnah with reference to the salient features of the Nehru Report (1928).

Better responses were the ones in which the candidates mentioned the amendment proposed by Muhammad Ali Jinnah to the Nehru Report and linked them with features of Nehru Report. They included federal constitution with residuary powers vested in the provinces; no less than one-third Muslim representation in the Central Legislature; in the event of the adult suffrage not being established, Punjab and Bengal also should have seats reserved on population basis for the Muslims, etc.

Example:

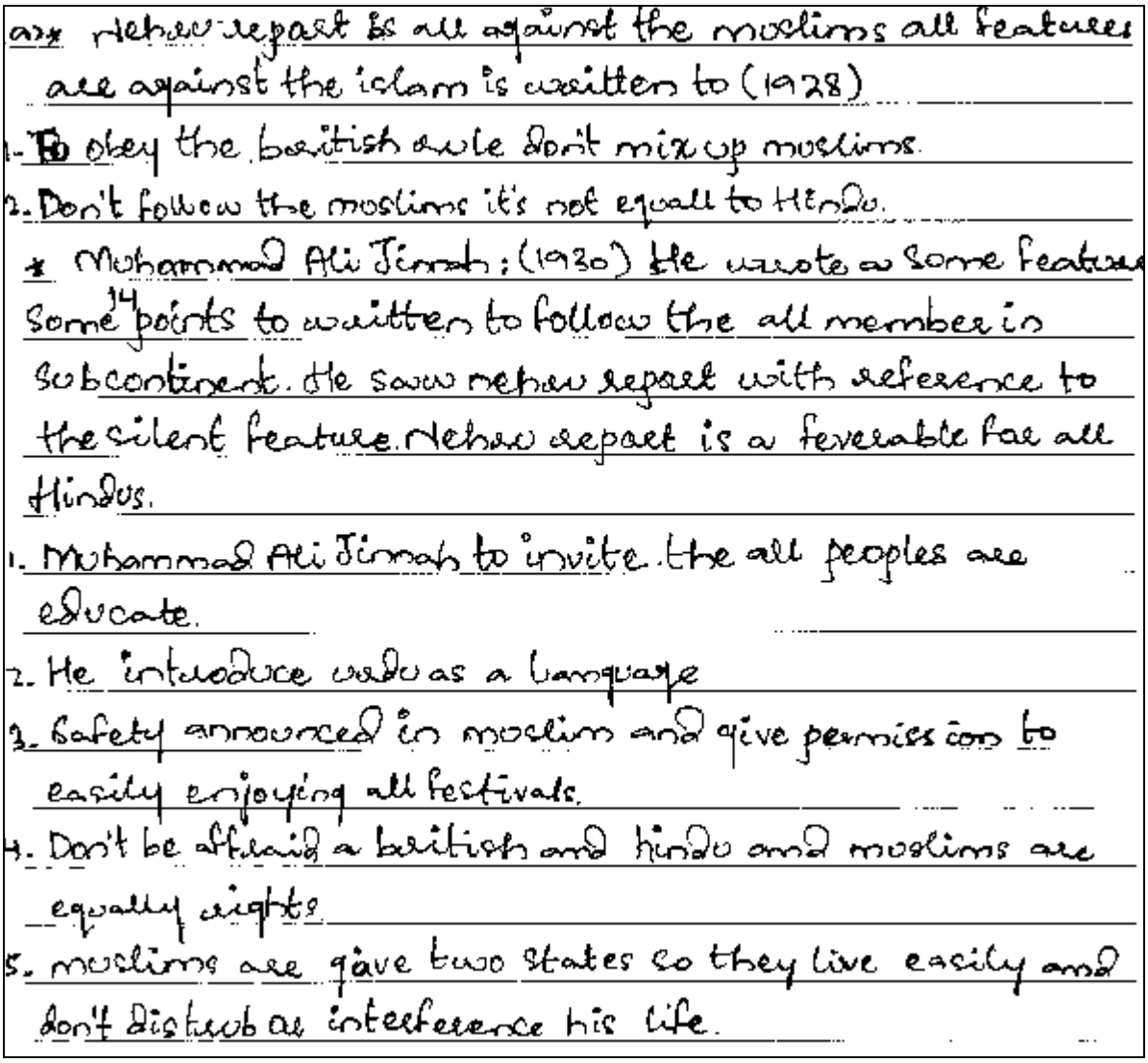
Quaid-e-Azam Muhammad Ali Jinnah presentor proposed his Recommendations or fourteen point in Response to the Recommendation of Nehru Reports.

- As Nehru Report Includes that there would be a strong federation with weak provinces. In Response Jinnah Recommendedthat there would be a weak federation with power Resting with the provinces.
- Nehru Rejected the Separate Electorates for the Muslim-s and other minorities while Jinnah wanted that Muslims should be provided with the separate Electorates.
- Nehru said that Muslim should be given 1/4rth Representation while Jinnah totally Rejected the idea of 1/4th Representation and Recommended that Muslims should be given 1/3rd Representation.

These were the three main Recommendation that Jinnah presented in Response of nehru's Recommendation which ~~are~~ were totally opposite of Lucknow pact, signed by Muslim league with congress.

Weaker responses could not comprehend the questions properly and talked about Jinnah's Fourteen Points instead. They also criticised Nehru Report without any logical or relevant arguments. As it was a choice question, very limited number of candidates chose to answer this question.

Example:


as* Nehru repart is all against the moslims all features are against the islam is written to (1928)

1- To obey the baritish rule don't mix up moslims.

2. Don't follow the moslims it's not equall to Hindu.

* Muhammad Ali Jinnah: (1930) He wrote a some features some 14 points to written to follow the all member in subcontinent. He saw nehru repart with reference to the silent feature. Nehru repart is a feverable for all Hindus.

1. Muhammad Ali Jinnah to invite the all peoples are educate.

2. He introduce urdu as a language

3. Safety announced in moslim and give permissions to easily enjoying all festivals.

4. Don't be afraid a baritish and hindu and moslims are equally rights.

5. moslims are gave two states so they live easily and don't disturb as interference his life.

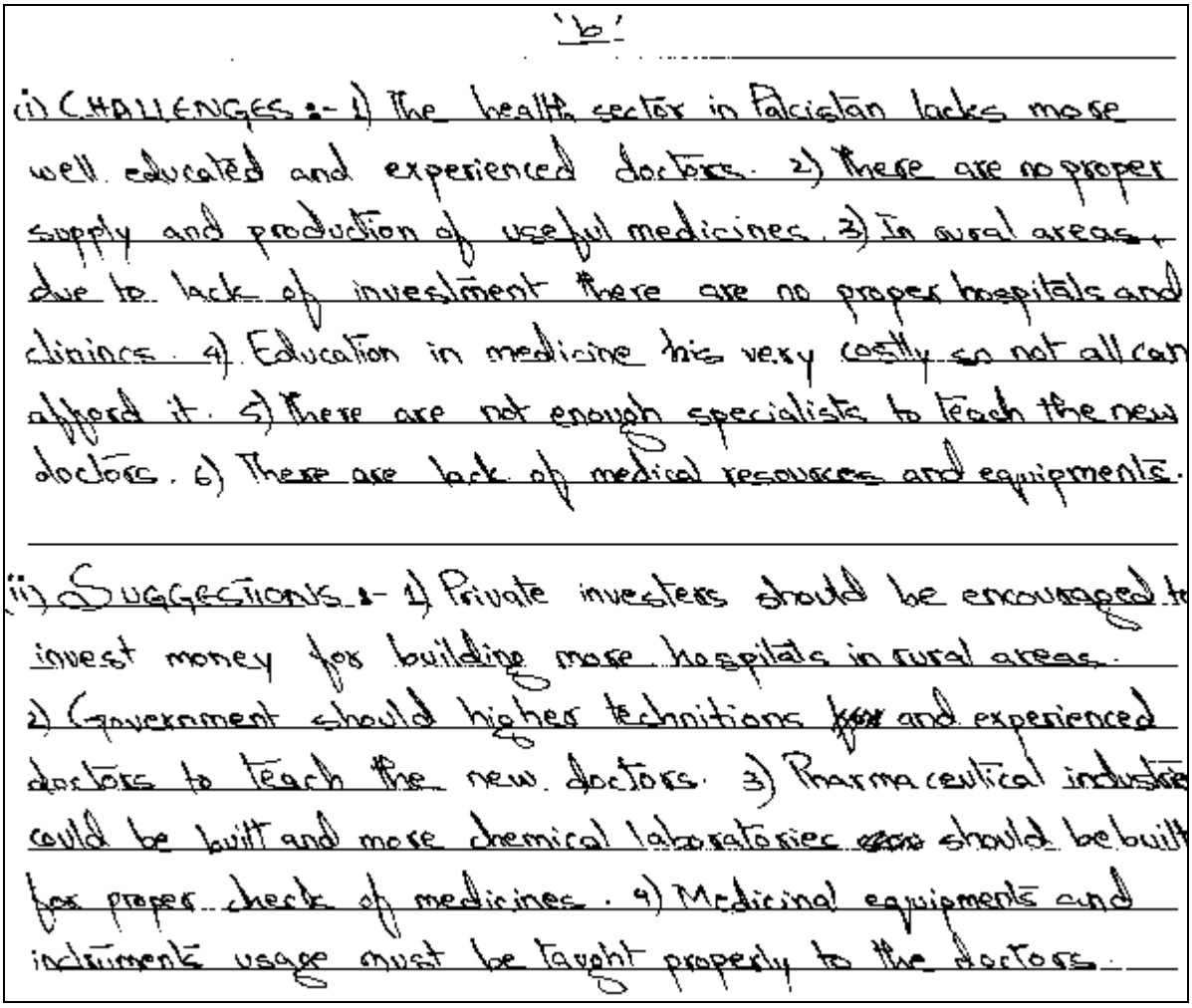
Question 10 b:

Mention any THREE challenges faced by the health sector in Pakistan.

Provide any TWO suggestions for how to overcome these challenge.

Better responses were the ones in which the candidates clearly mentioned challenges faced by the health sector in Pakistan. They included that Pakistan spends very little share of its gross domestic product (GDP) on health; shortage of health care professionals including nurses and doctors at all levels; non-functional hospitals and lack of commitment and dedication by health care personnel. They also clearly provided logical and relevant suggestion to overcome these challenges. In suggestions they included that the government should monitor public sectors in order to reduce corruption and increase the effectiveness of health service and Government should allocate sufficient resources for the health sector, etc.

Example:



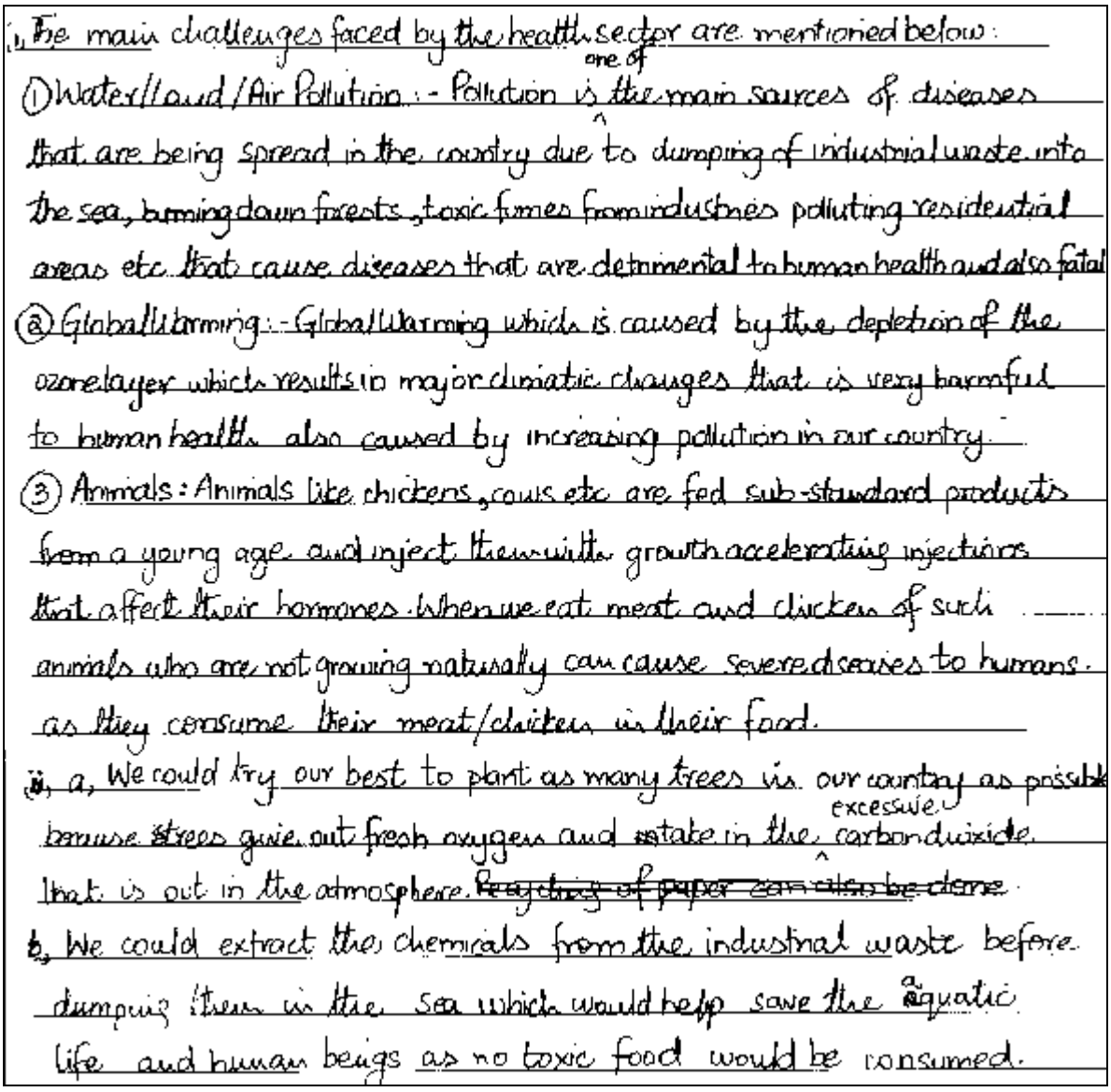
'b'

(i) CHALLENGES :- 1) The health sector in Pakistan lacks more well educated and experienced doctors. 2) There are no proper supply and production of useful medicines. 3) In rural areas, due to lack of investment there are no proper hospitals and clinics. 4) Education in medicine his very costly so not all can afford it. 5) There are not enough specialists to teach the new doctors. 6) There are lack of medical resources and equipments.

(ii) SUGGESTIONS :- 1) Private investers should be encouraged to invest money for building more hospitals in rural areas. 2) Government should higher technitions for and experienced doctors to teach the new doctors. 3) Pharmaceutical industries could be built and more chemical laboratories should be built for proper check of medicines. 4) Medicinal equipments and instruments usage must be taught properly to the doctors.

Weaker responses were the ones which were unable to highlight the problems faced by health sector in Pakistan. Most of them only talked about environmental challenges instead of discussing the problems of health sector. Some of the responses talked about the problems very vaguely and also did not offer any suggestion to overcome the challenges. It was a relatively easy question but those candidates who could not comprehend the question properly were not able to perform well.

Example:



i, The main challenges faced by the health sector are mentioned below:

(1) Water/Land/Air Pollution:- Pollution is one of the main sources of diseases that are being spread in the country due to dumping of industrial waste into the sea, burning down forests, toxic fumes from industries polluting residential areas etc. that cause diseases that are detrimental to human health and also fatal

(2) Global Warming:- Global Warming which is caused by the depletion of the ozone layer which results in major climatic changes that is very harmful to human health also caused by increasing pollution in our country.

(3) Animals: Animals like chickens, cows etc are fed sub-standard products from a young age and inject them with growth accelerating injections that affect their hormones. When we eat meat and chicken of such animals who are not growing naturally can cause severe diseases to humans as they consume their meat/chicken in their food.

ii, a, We could try our best to plant as many trees in our country as possible because trees give out fresh oxygen and intake in the excessive carbon dioxide that is out in the atmosphere. ~~Recycling of paper can also be done~~.

b, We could extract the chemicals from the industrial waste before dumping them in the sea which would help save the aquatic life and human beings as no toxic food would be consumed.